

Tips for your first game

Read this once before you score a live game. It covers the handful of things that trip up a new scorer — not everything the app does, which is in the **full guide**.

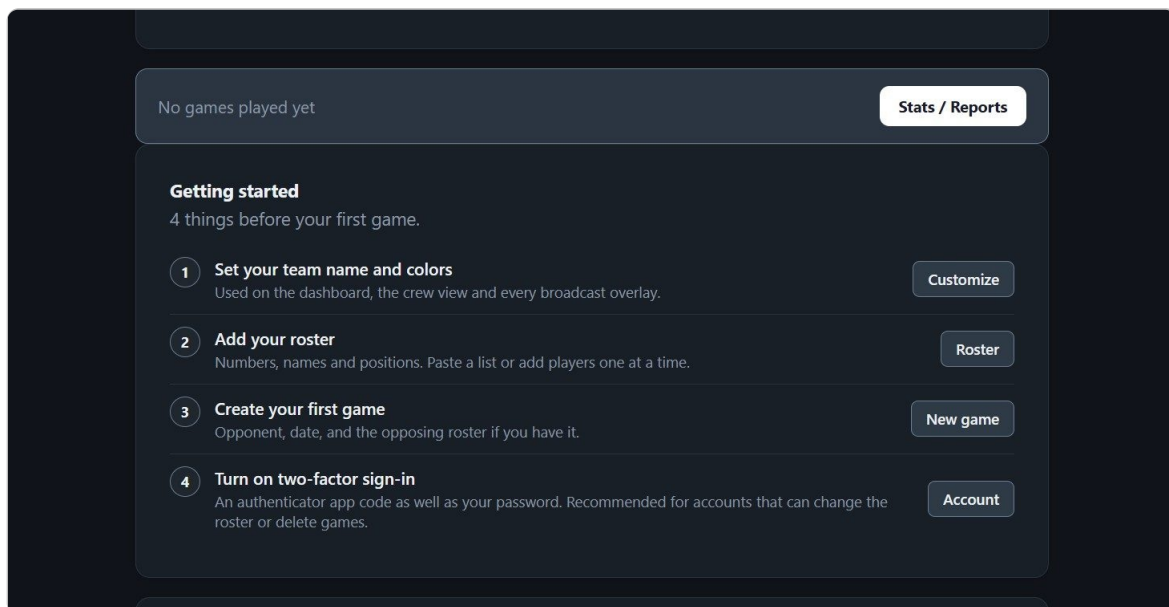
1. Practice first, on a game that does not count
2. Before kickoff
3. The rhythm of a play
4. When the app says no
5. Flags
6. What is optional, and what it costs
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1. Practice first, on a game that does not count

Do this before anything else. Twenty minutes here is worth more than any amount of reading, including this page.

1. Create a game called *Demo*
2. Tick **This is a preseason game** — it keeps everything out of your season totals
3. Upload any roster for the opponent; whose does not matter
4. Log plays, deliberately varied — rushes, a sack, a punt, a fumble, an interception, a field goal
5. Use **Reset game** from the dashboard game menu to clear it and start again

The best practice there is: find one of your school's games from last year on YouTube and enter the stats while you watch. That is exactly how this app was tested during development. Nothing else prepares you as well, because nothing else moves at the speed a real game moves.



The **Getting started** card tracks the four things a new tenant needs and disappears once they are done.

2. Before kickoff

Three things, in this order. The Getting started card on your dashboard follows the same order.

Step	What matters
Customize	Logo and colors. Your primary is picked up automatically; white is almost always the right secondary, because it is the one that stays readable on every background an overlay lands on.
Roster	Three columns: number, name, position. A header row is fine. Nothing else in the sheet — no blank rows, no totals.
New game	Have the opponent's roster to hand <i>before</i> you start. You will be asked for it partway through.

 **Customize team**

[← Dashboard](#)

Your team's name, logo, and colors — shown across the dashboard.

Team name (used everywhere in stat entry)

Bayou High

Full name (shown on the dashboard)

Bayou High School

Current season

2026

New games default to this year.

Logo

Choose file

Colors below auto-fill from the logo — still yours to adjust.



Primary color

Secondary color





Save

Your primary color is picked from the logo automatically. White is almost always the right secondary, because it stays readable on every background an overlay lands on.

New Game

[← Dashboard](#)

Set this game up now, start entering stats whenever you're ready — no need to do both at once.

Game designator

G1

Season year

2026

Date

08/28/2026



Quarter length (minutes)

12

Opponent name

Red Stick

Home or away?

Home

☐ This is a preseason game

Your roster

Pulled automatically from your Team Roster page.

78 players loaded from your roster

4 numbers are shared by an offensive and a defensive player. These were logged correctly on both sides and need nothing from you — each picker only offers the player who plays that role.

Likely starters (optional) — the offense picker starts with just these, and grows as anyone else gets entered during the game

QB 14 RB1 5 RB2 3 WR1 13 WR2 19 WR3 4

✓ QB #14 — Hayden Jones

✓ RB1 #5 — Christian Parker

✓ RB2 #3 — Jose Campbell

✓ WR1 #13 — Colton Hamilton

✓ WR2 #19 — Trevor Castillo

✓ WR3 #4 — Christian Ramos

Naming likely starters is optional, but it is what makes the pickers short in the first quarter. Anyone else you enter during the game joins the list as you go.

Opponent roster

Fresh upload for this specific game, same as always.

Upload opponent roster (.xlsx)
Skip roster (manual entry only)

Currently saved: 98 opponent player(s). Upload a new file below only if you need to replace it.

Likely starters (optional)

QB 7
RB1 4
RB2 2
WR1 16
WR2 11
WR3 88

QB #7 is shared — which player?

✓ Brian Jimenez
Eli Watson

✓ RB1 #4 — Liam Jackson
✓ RB2 #2 — Carson Wilson
✓ WR1 #16 — Cooper Russell
✓ WR2 #11 — Trevor Price
✓ WR3 #88 — Jeremiah Foster

Opponent branding (optional)

Choose logo


Primary color


Secondary color


Save changes
Cancel

When two opponents share a jersey number the app asks once, here, rather than mid-drive. Answering now is the difference between a tap and a decision while the clock runs.

Positions decide who appears where. Quarterbacks show in the passer list, backs and receivers in the carrier list, kickers in the kickoff picker. A player with no position, or a position the app does not recognize, will not appear in any of them — which is the single most common reason a scorer cannot find somebody mid-play.

 Bayou High Roster

← Dashboard

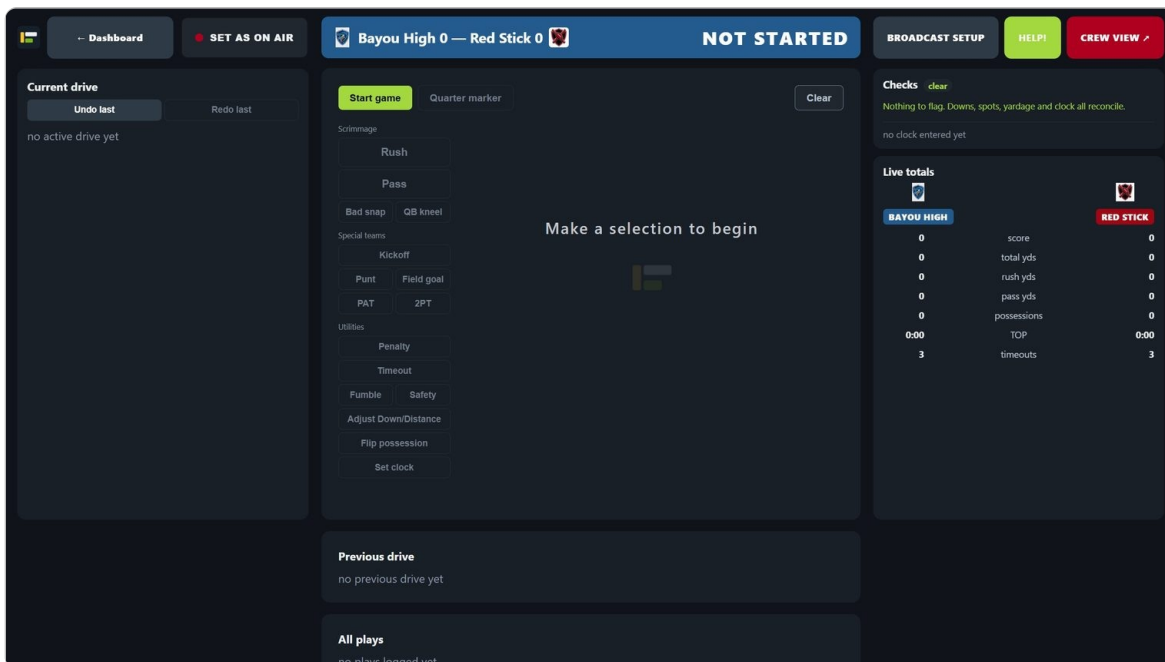
This roster is used every week — no need to re-upload it per game.

Season 2026 (current) ▾

Upload roster spreadsheet (.xlsx)Clear this season's roster

#0 Dominic Moreno	Offense	
RB	Edit	Remove
#0 Tristan Cole	Defense	
SS	Edit	Remove
#1 Hudson Perez	Offense	
QB, WR	Edit	Remove
#10 Jonathan Moore	Defense	
CB	Edit	Remove
#11 Luke Ramos	Offense	
TE, DE	Edit	Remove
#12 Riley Morris	Defense	
FS, S	Edit	Remove
#13 Colton Hamilton	Offense	
QB	Edit	Remove
#14 Hayden Jones	Offense	
WR	Edit	Remove

Each player picks up a unit badge from their position. Check these after an upload — a misaligned spreadsheet column shows up here as a wrong badge.



Before you press Start game the whole rail is dimmed and only Start game is live. Nothing is broken — a play cannot be entered into a game that has not begun.

3. The rhythm of a play

Every play is the same four questions, and after a quarter or so your hands stop needing to think about them.

	Question	Where
1	What kind of play?	The ladder down the left
2	Who?	The picker at the top of the panel
3	How far?	The yards box, or the calculator
4	What happened after?	Touchdown, fumble, spot

Then **Review play**, read the sentence it produces, and **Save**. Reading the sentence is the habit worth building: it is written in plain English precisely so that a wrong entry looks wrong.

1st

own 27

10

20

30

40

50

40

30

20

10

Field position

← Red Stick

Hide

Quarter marker

End 1st half

Clear

Scrimmage

Rush

Pass

Bad snap

QB kneel

Kickoff

Punt

Field goal

PAT

2PT

Penalty

Timeout

Fumble

Safety

Adjust Down/Distance

Flip possession

Set clock

Ball carrier

7 Jimenez

4 Jackson

2 Wilson

16 Russell

11 Price

88 Foster

7

Enter yards

8

LOSS

0

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

Or enter tackled on

Red Stick

Bayou High

yard line

Fumbled

Safety

+ Tackled by

Touchdown

Review play

Clear

A rush: play type, carrier, yards. Three taps and a number.

10

20

30

40

50

40

30

20

10

Field position

← Red Stick

Hide

Quarter marker

End 1st half

Clear

Scrimmage

Rush

Pass

Bad snap

QB kneel

Special teams

Kickoff

Punt

Field goal

PAT

2PT

Utilities

Penalty

Timeout

Fumble

Safety

Adjust Down/Distance

Flip possession

Set clock

Ball carrier

7 Jimenez

4 Jackson

2 Wilson

16 Russell

11 Price

88 Foster

7

Enter yards

8

LOSS

0

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

Fumbled

Safety

+ Tackled by

Touchdown

Review play

Clear

Or enter tackled on

Red Stick

Bayou High

35

from own 27 to own 35 = +8

The same rush entered the other way: give where he was tackled and the app works out the yards. Useful when you saw the spot but not the gain — which is most of the time from a press box.

Kickoff

Red Stick returns.

Returner

no one credited yet — type a number below

type #

Touchback

Out of bounds

Muff / Fumble

Onside kick

Fielded at

Bayou High

Red Stick

5

Returned to

Bayou High

Red Stick

27

Return: 22 yds

RETURN YARDS

+22

Fumbled during the return

Touchdown

Ball spot after the return (sets 1st down for Red Stick)

Red Stick's side

Bayou High's side

27

Clock

1152

no clock entered yet

Save return

← Back — undo the kickoff

A return is two spots, never a typed number. Fielded at, returned to, and the app shows what it worked out underneath.

StatChat — tips for your first game

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The screenshot shows the StatChat app interface. At the top is a football field diagram with yard lines from 10 to 50 on both sides of the 50-yard line. A yellow vertical line marks the 1st quarter. A white circle labeled 'opp 22' is positioned on the 22-yard line. Below the field diagram are buttons for 'Quarter marker' and 'End 1st half', and a 'Clear' button. The 'Scrimmage' section contains buttons for 'Rush', 'Pass' (highlighted in green), 'Bad snap', and 'QB kneel'. The 'Special teams' section contains buttons for 'Kickoff', 'Punt', 'Field goal', 'PAT', and '2PT'. The 'Utilities' section contains buttons for 'Penalty' (highlighted in yellow), 'Timeout', 'Fumble', 'Safety', 'Adjust Down/Distance', 'Flip possession', and 'Set clock'. On the right, a 'Parsed as' section shows the text 'Trevor Price (Red Stick) intercepted by Jaxson Williams (Bayou High)' with a checked box for 'Change of possession — Bayou High ball'. Below this, the 'Clock' is set to '22' and the 'Last entered' time is '1:00 (Q1)'. At the bottom of this section are 'Save' (highlighted in green), 'Edit', and 'Clear' buttons.

Read this sentence before saving. It is the cheapest error check in the app.

4. When the app says no

Two moments make a new scorer think something is broken. Neither is.

The spot, at a change of possession

Whenever the ball changes hands you must give **a side of the field and a yard line**. Review play refuses without both and says which is missing.

This one is worth understanding rather than just obeying. The spot is not really a statistic — it is what every later yardage check depends on. Without it the app has no idea where the ball is, so it stops being able to tell you that a 40-yard gain from the opponent's 12 is impossible. **A missing spot does not lose a number; it stops wrong numbers being caught.**

Field position

1st opp 22

10 20 30 40 50 40 30 20 10

← Red Stick

Hide

Quarter marker End 1st half Clear

Scrimmage

Rush

Pass

Bad snap QB kneel

Special teams

Kickoff

Punt Field goal

PAT 2PT

Utilities

Penalty

Timeout

Fumble Safety

Adjust Down/Distance

Flip possession

Set clock

Completed / incomplete Sacked ✓ Intercepted

Passer 11 Price 7 Jimenez or type #

Intended re... 2 Wilson 4 Jackson 16 Russell

11 Price 88 Foster 16

Intercepted... no one credited yet — type a number below type #

Downed in the end zone — touchback

Touchdown

Fumbled on the return

Starting spot for the ensuing drive

Bayou High's side Red Stick's side Yard line

Review play Clear

An interception, with the ensuing-drive spot still blank. Press Review play now and it refuses, naming what is missing — a side of the field, a yard line, or both.

The kickoff, at the start of a half

The guided kickoff needs a kicker *and* a direction. The direction is the only thing that tells the app which way each team is going, and it alternates by quarter from that one answer.

Kickoff

Bayou High kicks off.

Kicker

20 Mitchell

84 Mendoza

85 Jones

20

Which way is Bayou High kicking?

← left

right →

Nothing has been saved — still needed: which way Bayou High is kicking.

Save kickoff

← Back

Picked a kicker but not a direction. The message says so rather than the button quietly doing nothing.

Kickoff

Bayou High kicks off.

Kicker

20 Mitchell

84 Mendoza

85 Jones

20

Which way is Bayou High kicking?

← left

right →

Save kickoff

← Back

Both answered, and Save kickoff goes through. Direction is the only thing telling the app which way each team is going, and it alternates by quarter from this one answer.

5. Flags

Two things about penalties catch people out, and neither is obvious from the panel.

The play does not count

On an accepted penalty the play is wiped out entirely. A back who ran eight yards before holding was called gets **no attempt and no yards** — not eight, and not the four he had made when the foul happened. The down replays.

So enter the **penalty instead of the play**, not as well as it. Entering both leaves a rusher credited with yardage he did not gain, and that number looks perfectly reasonable in a stat line, which is what makes it worth being careful about.

Where the yards come off

Most fouls are marked off from where the ball started. A foul *during* a play often is not — it comes off the spot where the foul happened.

Tick **Enforce from spot of foul** and give a side and a yard line. A back runs 8 from your 30, holding at the 34: the ten yards come off the 34, so the ball ends on the 24. A net six, not ten. Leave the toggle off and it marks off from the 30 and puts the ball on the 20, which is not where the officials will spot it.

On a kickoff, enter the kickoff first with its ending spot set to wherever the penalty will be enforced from, then add the penalty.

6. What is optional, and what it costs

Some fields say *optional* and mean it. Knowing which is which is what lets you keep up during a fast drive.

Field	Skip it and...
The clock	Nothing is blocked. That possession is simply not counted toward time of possession. Enter it at each change and TOP works; skip it and TOP is incomplete rather than wrong. On a kickoff, read it as the ball is fielded — the change of possession is the catch, not the tackle. The return time belongs to the receiving team, and a clock read after the runner is down hands the whole return to the kicking team instead.
The returner	The return still counts for the team. Only the individual credit is lost.
Tackled by	The play is unaffected. Only that tackler's count is missed.
The spot	Not optional. See above.

When you fall behind, skip the optional fields and keep the plays. A game with every play and some missing tacklers is a good game. A game missing three plays is not, and no amount of detail elsewhere repairs it.

7. Five things that are not NFL rules

StatChat follows **NFHS**, which matches NCAA on the points below and differs from the NFL. If you have watched a lot of professional football these will feel wrong at first, and they are not.

- **Sack yardage is charged to team rushing**, not to the quarterback's passing.
- **A quarterback kneel is a team rush**, not an individual one.
- **A bad snap is a team rush** as well.
- **The defense cannot score on a try.** A blocked PAT returned the length of the field is worth nothing.
- **A missed field goal reaching the end zone is a touchback**, and the ball comes out to the 20.

The app already applies all five. You do not have to remember them while scoring — they are here so that the numbers make sense when somebody compares them against a professional broadcast and asks why they differ.

8. Your crew

Two things worth showing your broadcast people before the first game, because both save you being interrupted mid-drive.

Crew view is a live read-only page. Anyone with the link can watch the score, the current drive and the leaders update as you enter plays, on any device. It is built for a phone.

Broadcast setup holds every overlay and data feed — XML for a scoreboard, HTML pages for vMix browser inputs. Hand those links to whoever runs the switcher and they can build their graphics before game day.

The screenshot displays the StatChat Crew View interface for a game between Bayou High and Red Stick. The interface is divided into several sections:

- Scoreboard:** Shows the current score (Bayou High 17, Red Stick 14) and the quarter (Q2). It also displays the time of possession (TOL) for each team.
- Team Stats:** A grid showing various statistics for both teams, including Possessions, Total Yards, Pass Yards, Rush Yards, Total Plays, Turnovers, Penalties, and 3rd Down conversions.
- Current Drive:** Shows the current drive statistics (1/49 Rush, 0/0 Pass, 1/64 Total) and the time of possession (0:00). It also displays the previous drive statistics.
- Player Stats:** Detailed statistics for individual players, categorized by Passing, Receiving, Rushing, Defense, and Special Teams.

The interface is designed to be mobile-friendly, with a dark theme and clear, legible text.

Crew view, mid-game. Nobody needs to ask you the score.

Play entry itself wants a laptop or an iPad. Open a game on a phone and you will get a notice saying so. You can continue anyway, but the buttons stack into a column and the play panel drops below the fold, which is how a wrong number gets saved. Crew view, recaps and reports are all fine on a phone.

The full guide, covering everything this page skips, is at statchat.co/help.html